

Transcript 11

So yeah, thank you so much for participating. I want to talk a bit about homesickness in general, combined with voice recordings, something about meaningfulness and how personal voice recordings can feel to you. And I just want to start off by asking you how you're feeling today.

Yeah, fine today. Yeah, I guess. Fine. Yeah, just a normal day. A bit stressful. I'm finishing my master's, so pressure's on. But yeah, other than that, I'm okay today.

That's very relatable. All right, so to check, could you tell me where you're from originally?

Yeah, I'm from Ireland, from a county called Donegal. A town called Letterkenny. Yeah, all right.

And so did you grow up there as well?

Yeah.

All right. And where do you currently live?

I currently live in Amsterdam. In IJburg.

In IJburg, okay.

And do you remember a moment where you felt most homesick in your life? Or at least a lot of homesickness? Do you know where you were? What were you missing?

Yeah. Yeah, I think generally when I feel very stressed. Yeah. I feel most homesick. Like, I just want to kind of go home. Yeah. And I feel like there's a lot of people here and there's not so many people at home and that's also something that I miss. Just being able to, you know, drive around or go to a beach and there'll be no one there. That's kind of something I took for granted, I think. Yeah.

Yeah, I can understand.

And what do you consider to be home?

Um, my bedroom and my mom, definitely. Just being around that environment. Yeah. With my mom, definitely.

Yeah. All right. And I want to move on to questions about how personal or generic voice recording can sound to you. And so I'm studying that effect. Well, among other things. And so personal voice audio, I kind of mean any form of voice recordings that resonate with you personally. And that doesn't necessarily mean it needs to be from someone very close to you. But it needs to invoke a personal connection. So it could be linguistic, cultural, historical connection. It just needs to invoke a personal connection. And any generic voice recording would be one that doesn't invoke that connection. So if you were to think about voice recordings in general, that you might be able to think of that exist or might exist. Which types of recordings do you think would be more personal to you? What would be the characteristics of that?

Like a voicemail kind of thing or like from WhatsApp or like?

Could be. Yeah, it's very broad. So it could be a lot of things. Yeah.

Yeah. Okay. Um. Yeah, I don't know. It's actually a very difficult question. Um. I don't know. I. I guess it depends on the person. Yeah. That you're hearing it from. Um. Like for example, if it was my sister's or my mother. Yeah. I think it would make me feel a bit more sick. Actually than anything else. Yeah. Uh. To me. Um. Yeah. It means like. If it's from my sister's, it would be something like. Exciting has just happened. And they want to get all the information in there as fast as possible. But if it was from like. My mom or. Someone older. It would make me feel a bit sick. Because something's happened. I think. To me that's. I think. I don't know. Yeah. And. And do you think. Uh. Something could also be more personal for you. Based on a topic maybe. On the way people are speaking. Um. If they are emotional. Then. Yes. I think a topic about. Um. Family or friends. Or. Stuff that's obviously very emotional. But if it's with regards to. Arbitrary things that I really. I'm not very involved in. Then no. But definitely. If they are emotional. Or something. Um. Affects them. It will. Uh. Affect me. Yeah.

Yeah. and you already said that. If there's something that. Doesn't really interest you. Or maybe that you're not really involved in. Do you think that would be more generic for you?

Yeah.

Is there anything else that you can think of? It might be a bit more difficult question. Anything else you can think of that's. Maybe more generic.

Um. Uh. Uh. Yeah. I don't know.

That's okay. That's a completely fine answer. You don't have to have a. Have an answer for everything. Um. I'm. What I'm gonna do is. I'm gonna actually send you a. Um. A link. I'm gonna grab it now. It's a link to another questionnaire. And what I

want you to do. Is just open that during this meeting. And just keep it open at all times during the interview. And. Uh. I'm gonna actually. Well. The first question you're gonna have. Is to fit in another. Email address. Or phone number. Whichever one you filled in. Uh. Just so I can connect the answers later. And then I'm gonna. Let you hear five different voice recordings. The first questions are gonna be. About the personalness or genericness. So. They're gonna ask you to rate it on a scale of one to seven. One being very generic. Seven being very personal. And anything in between. Um. And you can rate the recordings. I'm gonna let you hear. So you're gonna see a description. In the first question. About. Someone in the. From a different country. Talking in a different language. You are not really familiar with. About the weather. The first recording is gonna correspond with that. And the second question. Is already for the second recording. So each statement is for one recording. So I'll just let you hear this. Um. Please let me know. Uh. If you cannot really hear it. If anything is unclear. And also you can let me know. When you want to move on to the next one.

Okay.

All right. So you're ready for the. For the first recording.

Yep.

All right.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

All right.

Next one.

Yeah.

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

All right.

Yep.

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

Okay so you filled those five in, so for the next part you're going to have a kind go back to the interview again and we're going to do this back and forth two more times yeah so based on these five recordings what do you think were characteristics of the voice recordings or of the contexts of the recordings that kind of affected that person on the score did anything make it more generic or more personal?

Um well i also i think i'm going to be i think it was french and i don't speak french yeah um but i feel like french is uh can be very seem very passionate in the way they express themselves quite expressive people when they speak french so i because i don't know what they were saying to me it felt quite personal yeah i couldn't understand anything, but yeah um just in the the way they express their their their words is very uh passionate to me so i would consider that very personal yeah um. Uh with also the tone so if the tone is very like subtle or light to me it doesn't feel like it's very personal it feels uh neutral or maybe generic, but if something is more means more or is more then um there's like a a deeper tone or it's pause kind of to emphasize what you want to say yeah that would mean more personal to me

Yeah exactly um so for the three recordings that you could kind of understand linguistically um was there any difference between those three recordings?

I think the last one to me was not very was very it was very generic yeah to me um second last one as well where i just find at their news reporters and uh the news one the last one yet uh st paddies day is more for i think it's less for irish people and more for international so yeah in the sense that it's personal it's not so very personal it's very generic yeah like the topic is more touristy than that it's actually kind of attractive to the irish people themselves yeah and the tone as well it's just something you know you're just trying it's something like you know you're just being polite and entertaining but it's not personal to them or to people watching maybe more targeted towards others yeah

Yeah okay um so i want to move on to the meaningfulness of a voice recording and that's kind of a bit of a nuanced difference it's a small difference like um by that i kind of mean if a voice recording feels in any way important to you or maybe relevant familiar um so it's it can also resonate of course just like personalness but to what extent that actually means something to you and it can be emotionally but it can also feel important without emotions reminding you maybe of something valuable and the recording could be very personal but not that meaningful like maybe the example you gave uh with the french um and vice versa so it could be not that not that personal but it could still be meaningful of course, um so if you were to think about voice recordings again in general, what do you think might make one more meaningful or less meaningful?

I don't know um the topic yes i don't know it's very yeah very broad yeah could be anything um yeah i'm not sure definitely the topic for me um who it's from and and the tone if someone's sincere when they're trying to say something or if someone's just saying something for the sake of being someone you know when someone says happy birthday yeah and you get like a 20 texts from other people that didn't know it was your birthday yeah but the person knew it was your birthday kind of like that yeah

Yeah exactly and do you think there's like a correlation between the meaningfulness and the personalness?

Yeah yeah

All right and uh do you think or well i'm gonna ask you can tell me if you can come up with something can you think of a situation or situations in which the same exact voice recording would be more meaningful in one situation and less meaningful in another so with different situations some examples are being alone or being with others feeling homesick or not maybe being at home or in public all those types of things are kind of contrasting situations?

Oh i don't know it's very difficult i think if you're feeling alone homesick feeling alone is not necessarily wanting help i mean you can feel alone but you don't want maybe other people to feel that you're alone a lot of people don't like the pity or or this reassurance that they can be interpreted the wrong way in a voice no or whatever but definitely if you're feeling homesick then you want to be wanted or want to be going home but being alone i think can be different for different people so i think if you send the message, it can be interpreted badly if i felt homesick and my mom told me oh you should come home, yeah i would want to yes but if i maybe felt alone and i was just in my feelings i didn't necessarily want anyone to know and my mom said oh you should come home you know, I might get defensive and be like no i'm okay here i'm fine you know the same message can be interpreted differently depending yeah i don't know that would be my only example.

Yeah no sounds good um so i want to go back to the questionnaire now um i'm gonna let you hear the same five recordings again and you can think of the meaningfulness for those um if it's the same that's completely fine you can just give the answers the way you feel like uh the way you feel they are fitting

Yeah all right

So let let me know when you're ready for the first one

Yeah

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

So going back to the questions and once again just based on the recordings you just heard, what do you think are elements of the situations and of the context that made it more meaningful or less meaningful?

Um the yeah the topics weather obviously is not that meaningful it's neutral or yeah neutral not meaningful um historical speeches i would consider to be quite meaningful definitely if you're passionate yeah. Yeah but with regards to weather and i mean interviewing some people no i don't find that meaningful

Yeah so with the national holiday of course this one is a bit touristy, do you think it's still more meaningful than it's than that it's personal?

Yeah, yeah i don't know why, I find that very difficult to explain like I find it difficult to separate those two i can't imagine something being meaningful without being personal

Yeah no i understand that, that's completely fine it's difficult questions so that's uh no problem um so finally i want to move on to the actual homesickness relief so coping with homesickness and i kind of mean if a voice recording um feels like it would be supportive in coping with homesickness and would actually alleviate your feelings of homesickness and to what extent or maybe worsen your homesickness and to what extent? So if you once again think about voice recordings in general what do you think might make a voice reporting impact this homesickness coping what might make it better what might make it worse?

I think it's always nice to hear a voice note if you're uh feeling homesick i think it makes you feel warm i mean if it's like for your for me for my mom it's always nice to hear a voice of course if nothing's wrong it's always nice to hear a voice um i think discussing what we could do when i do go home like plans that we can make or stuff that we can do together or um dinners that she'll cook or food that i miss stuff like that yeah i think those will give me something to hope for and look forward to um give me inspiration yeah i think that's definitely what would kind of quell my my homesickness feeling um i think for the opposites um if for example someone said oh you can always come home that is something that's always very nice to hear like you know whatever for whatever reason you're feeling homesick that there's nothing in your way to prevent you from rescuing that feeling but also it can give you a sense like oh you know um there's no confidence or maybe you've failed or something like that i think that also plays a huge role thing yeah so i think that's something i wouldn't like to hear

Yeah exactly and uh could you once again think of maybe two situations in which the same recording would feel more supportive for coping with homesickness in the one situation and less supportive or maybe even worsening in another?

Well I think so far i don't know if i'm gonna answer your question properly but like for example um because i'm at the end of my studies and i'm very stressed and making sure i get everything in on time and that i've you know submitted the right things that makes me feel very yeah i do feel homesick and i want to go home because at home

i feel most relaxed and i've got you know a little worry about or whatever but i think uh hearing a voice note saying oh you can come home um i feel like that would not help me uh it would it would make me feel maybe a bit it would lessen the pressure so i feel like i wouldn't have to be so prepared like everything is okay and it happens but if i kind of lose focus then i will slack on something and then i will i just feel like um silence works best actually when i'm under severe severe stress because then i just focus on what i need to do even though i do feel a bit homesick. But if i didn't get a message it would just be nice to look forward to planning things and stuff that would make me feel a bit more, yeah, hopeful yeah inspiration

All right yeah and to go back to the questionnaire one last time um i just want to let you hear the same recordings again um and this time you can rate them based on how supportive you think they are for coping with homesickness okay um yeah so after filling in these five you can just submit the questionnaire by the way then it's done okay um so let me know when you're ready

All right

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

So do you think there's any elements of the recordings that made it specifically supportive for you or maybe pretty neutral or worsened it?

Maybe yeah I think from the Irish ones the last few it's very um uplifting yeah spoken with uh yeah passion there is like uh obviously the president speaking is quite empowering and stuff and obviously hearing an accent that you recognize is also uh supportive yeah um yeah definitely yeah. I think and the French ones are just nice they just feel supportive anyway yeah like if someone came at you with that you'd feel supported so yeah that just sounded nice for like the tones of voice.

And between the three uh Irish ones do you think there's a specific one that was like the highest in supportiveness for you if any of the three?

Um the first one or the last one yeah so the weather um and the national holiday, yeah, just uh I don't know just the tone and, and maybe st paddies day is obviously celebrating something nice so it is nice to reminisce and I mean the top one you hear every day so it's something you you recognize every evening. Yeah so yeah.

Exactly. Okay so I want to move on to the final couple of questions so I kind of want to imagine you receiving a voice recording and maybe you actually have a specific one in mind of someone very close to you such a like a loved one family member

and they're speaking to you directly about something personal um first of all how meaningful do you think that would feel to you and how supportive for coping with homesickness do you think it would be and why?

Um I think it would definitely help yeah definitely I think it would be very emotional yeah obviously if you feel homesick you're very vulnerable and you just kind of want to go on and you do feel isolated and everything like that. And no one can understand you because it's not yeah you know what you're used to. I definitely would be very emotional but uh it would be very helpful

Yeah exactly, and do you think there's just a variable of like the distance between you two, does that have any effect on the supportiveness?

Yeah definitely I think I think it increases the support like no matter how far away you are that you get a message and it's usually you know very comforting huh so yeah I think yeah yeah definitely, I think distance does show you how strong it could be.

Yeah exactly okay um and is there anything that we haven't covered yet that might occur to you um about voice recordings about homesickness about anything that you think is important to share in this context?

Um I think you've covered everything

All right yeah and then one final question and you can share if you want you don't have to but um. If you could choose one type of voice recording or one specific voice recording that you would maybe use if you were feeling homesick and you really want to alleviate your own homesickness, you think it will be really useful for that, uh, what comes to mind for you?

Um um I think a voice note from my mom voice recording from my mom yeah um yeah or or my best friend

And do you think that needs to be about a certain something or does it need to have a certain tone, or just could be anything?

It could be anything yeah it could be, yeah it could be about the weather or whatever I just think like if you feel homesick, it's usually, you're missing it. It's like you're missing everything about home and the feeling that you're so used to feeling and stuff, and I think just hearing from you know, an accent you're familiar with or a conversation you know, you can have, just stuff like that would just help.

Yeah all right thank you so much, um, yeah that was it right now. I'm just gonna turn off the recording right here